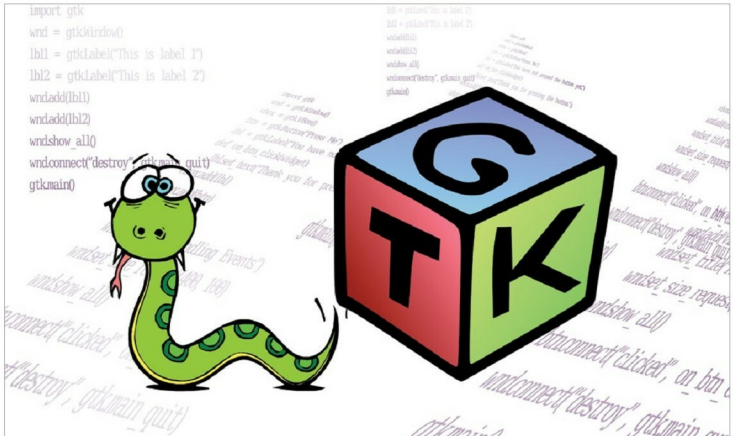


GUI Programming

Getting Started with PyGTK

This is an introduction to GUI programming with PyGTK. The approach is simple and is supported with practical examples. A must read for those who intend to create GUI programs.



Typically, programming lessons start with console applications, whose black and white screens make most of us feel bored. But we all dream of creating programs with buttons and mouse support, just like any other application. This tutorial introduces you to PyGTK, a popular toolkit used to create such programs.

What is GUI programming?

The key features of GUIs or graphical user interfaces are windows, controls like buttons and text boxes, and mouse support. These help the user to operate the computer easily. So, all end user applications are created with a GUI.

But most popular programming languages, including C, C++ and Python, don't support native graphical interface designing. Although Visual Basic supports native GUI programming and is a popular choice among beginners, it is not recommended by experts. VB lacks portability, the power of languages like C, and ultimately, freedom since it

is proprietary software. So we have to use a widget toolkit with our favourite language. Widget toolkits help us to create and manage windows and controls. GTK+ and Qt are the most popular widget toolkits. You can find these names in the recipes of many popular software packages and in the requirement lists of major companies' 'Get Hired!' pages.

How does a GUI program work?

How a command line program works is straightforward. It starts, prompts for and accepts some data, one step at a time, processes the inputs and exits once the output is displayed. Consider the following Python code for a simple calculator:

```
print("Enter two numbers: ")
a = input()
b = input()
print("The sum is ")
print(a+b)
```